In the context of 20th-century San Francisco high society and the **Bohemian Club**, names were often used interchangeably for three specific reasons:

1. The "Social Name" vs. The "Legal Name"

In elite circles like the Cave Man camp, members often went by a "Social Name" (Tom) that differed from their legal first name (Wallis).

- **Wallis Richard Riese Jr.** was legally "Wallis," but to his fellow Bohemians and real estate partners, he was **"Tom."**
- When signing **Trustee** documents or real estate deeds, he might use **"Thomas J. Riese"** or **"Wallis R. Riese"** depending on which family trust or corporate entity (e.g., a "Thomas J. Riese Trust") was being represented.

2. Catholic Naming Traditions (Confirmation Names)

The Riese family had strong ties to the SFPD and the Catholic community (buried at **Holy Cross**).

- It was common for men to adopt their confirmation name—frequently **"Joseph"** or **"James"**—as a middle initial (**Thomas J.**) for business, even if it wasn't on their birth certificate.
- This helped distinguish between the "Wallis" who was the father (Sr.) and the "Wallis" who was the son (Tom) in public Real Estate records.

3. The "Junior" Avoidance

Under the Bohemian Club's 1932 Bylaws and general social etiquette of the era, many "Juniors" adopted a different name to establish their own professional identity.

- By going by **Tom** or **Thomas J.**, he could build a reputation in **San Francisco Real Estate** that was distinct from his father's legacy in the **Cave Man camp**, while still benefiting from the family's immense social capital.

Gravesite Confirmation

- **Wallis Riese Sr. (Cave Man):** Mount Tamalpais Cemetery, San Rafael.
- **Tom (Wallis Jr.):** Also at Mount Tamalpais Cemetery, often listed under his legal name "Wallis" on the headstone but remembered as Tom.
- **Ernie Riese (d. 1973):** Check the **Riese Family Plot** at Cypress Lawn in Colma, as this is where the brothers' real estate and SFPD business associates were traditionally interred.